

CURRICULUM VITAE

CHRISTIAN ALEMÁN-PERICÓN

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CURRENT APPOINTMENT

2023 - Today Postdoctoral Associate, NYU Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates

PAST POSITIONS

2022 Postdoctoral Fellow, ECARES (Université Libre Bruxelles) Brussels, Belgium

EDUCATION

2018 - 2022 Ph.D. Economics (*Cum Laude*), IDEA-Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, Spain
2020 Ph.D. Visiting Scholar, Dept. of Economics, University of Pennsylvania, USA
2016 - 2018 M.Sc. Master in Quantitative Economics, Paris1 Pantheon Sorbonne, France
2012 - 2015 B.A. Economics, (*Summa Cum Laude*) Universidad Privada Boliviana, Bolivia

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS / MEMBERSHIPS

American Economic Association (AEA), Canadian Economic Association (CAE), The Econometric Society-Cowles Foundation, European Economic Association (EEA), Latin American Economic Association (LAC)

FIELDS OF INTEREST

AI Machine Learning and the Macroeconomy, Labor Economics, Growth and Development, Inequality, Health, Family Economics, Econometric Methods, with applications to environmental policy, labor markets, human capital development, and healthcare in emerging economies.

My research lies in the field of Micro and Macroeconomics. I make use of structural quantitative models as tools to highlight the mechanisms behind empirical facts observed in the data. I have particular interest in developing AI and neural networks that challenge long-standing traditional structural modeling.

RESEARCH PAPERS

“Stage-Based Identification of Policy Effects” (with Christopher Busch, Alexander Ludwig and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis) Submitted, *Econometrica* 2024
“A Quantitative Theory of the HIV Epidemic: Education, Risky Sex and Asymmetric Learning” (with Daniela Iorio and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis) Submitted, *Review of Economic Studies* 2024.
“Kramer vs. Kramer. On the importance of Children and Divorce Filings for Understanding Divorce Rates in the USA”, NYUAD Working Paper 2024
“Evaluating the Effectiveness of Policy Against the Covid-19 Pandemic” (with Christopher Busch, Alexander Ludwig and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis) *Barcelona School of Economics Paper* 2023

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“Double Selection in Causal Inference” (with Christopher Busch, Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis and Tanya Surovtseva)
“Employment and Human Capital Investment Responses to Payroll Tax Reductions” (with Étienne Wasmer, Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis and Pranav Mimani)
“HIV Diffusion: Evidence from One Million Blood Tests” (with Daniela Iorio and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis)
“Agricultural Productivity in Bolivia before and after the 2006 reform” (with Sergio Bobka)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025	Research Specialization, AI and Machine Learning Essentials with Python, UPenn
2018	Research Internship, Banc Sabadell, Barcelona Spain
2017 (Summer)	Research Internship, Leibniz Institute for Economic Research Halle IWH Germany
2016	Research Internship, Central Bank of Bolivia-at the Advisory of Economic Policy
2013 - 2015	Research Assistant for Prof. Oscar Molina, Universidad Privada Boliviana

TEACHING EXPERIENCE Average student evaluations score: 4.3/5

2023 - 2024	Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
2022	Research Methods in Economics (Graduate), Université Libre de Bruxelles
2021	Teaching Assistant, Econometrics I (Graduate), Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona
2020	Instructor, Statistics II (Undergraduate), Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona
2013 - 2015	Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics II (Undergraduate), Universidad Privada Boliviana

SCHOLARSHIPS AND GRANTS

2025	Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich and NYU Colaboration Grant
2023 - 2025	PostDoctoral Research Fund Award
2018 - 2022	FPI PhD Scholarship from the Spanish Ministry of Science
2016 - 2018	Erasmus Mundus Scholarship: Full funding to pursue Master in Quantitative Economics, Université Paris1 Pantheon Sorbonne, France
2014	Goethe Institute-Bonn Excellence Scholarship: Full scholarship to participate in an advanced German-Language course in Bonn, Germany
2012-2015	Excellence Scholarship, Universidad Privada Boliviana

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

AI and Learning the Macroeconomy (2025, BSE-UAB, Spain), Society of Economic Dynamics Conference (2025, University of Copenhagen, Denmark), Canadian Economic Association Annual Meeting (2025, UQAM, Canada), McGill Economics Brown Bag Seminar (2025, McGill University, Canada), York Economics Seminar (2025, York University, Canada), New Frontiers for Policy Evaluation (2025, NYUAD, UAE), NYUAD PostDoc Seminar (2023-24-25, NYUAD, UAE), NYUAD Development Seminar (2025, NYUAD, UAE), Melbourne Economics Seminar, (2024, University of Melbourne, Australia), Queensland Economics Seminar, (2024, University of Queensland, Australia), Workshop of the Australian Macroeconomics Society WAMS-LAEF, (2024, University of Western Australia, Australia), Deakin Economics Brownbag, (2024, Deakin University, Australia), Macro-Development Workshop, (2024, Deakin University, Australia), Monash Economics Seminar, (2024, Monash University, Australia), Developments in the Theory and the Applications of Counterfactual Methods for Policy COMPIE (2024, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands), International Workshop on Migration and Family, Poster (2024, IESEG Paris, France), Barcelona Summer Forum, Income Dynamics and the Family (2024, UAB-BSE, Spain), NYUAD Health and Demography Seminar (2024, NYUAD, UAE), NYUAD Inequality Seminar (2024, NYUAD, UAE), NYUAD Global Dynamics Seminar (2024, NYUAD, UAE), AFEPOP Inaugural Conference (2024, Ecole des Hautes Etudes en Sciences Sociales, France), NYUAD Economics Brownbag Seminar (2023, NYUAD, UAE), Society of Economics of the Household SEHO (2023, University of Copenhagen, Denmark), Workshop on Families, Human Capital, and Inequality, Poster (2023, Mannheim University, Germany), Household Economics Gathering (2022, KU Leuven, Belgium), Leuven Summer Event (2022, KU Leuven, Belgium), DTMC Workshop on Interactions between Labor and Marriage Markets (2022, Aarhus University, Denmark), Essex-Barcelona Workshop on Labor Economics (2021, UAB, Spain), Macro Club, UAB internal seminar series (2019-20-21-22, UAB, Spain), Barcelona School of Economics Ph.D Jamboree (2018-19 UAB-Pompeu Fabra, Spain), IMF Gender and Macroeconomics Conference, Poster (2017 Washington DC, USA), 7th Bolivian Conference on Development Economics (2016 UPSA, Bolivia).

COMPUTER SKILLS

MATLAB, STATA, R, Eviews Python, Julia, (HPC & parallel computing), LaTeX, MS Office, Bloomberg

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Spanish-Mother Tongue, English-Fluent TOEFLiBT grade:107, German-Fluent, TestDaF Level C1, French-Fluent DELF Level B2, Catalan-Medium, Level B1, Arabic-Basic

CITIZENSHIP: Spain

RECIDENCY: UAE Golden Visa holder

DOB: June 1994

RESEARCH ABSTRACTS

The following abstracts summarize key job-market research projects and working papers

Stage-Based Identification of Policy Effects (2024) joint with Christopher Busch, Alexander Ludwig and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis

We develop a new econometric method that identifies the effects of public policy implemented nationwide---i.e. across all regions at the same time. Starting point is the insight that the dynamics of many outcome variables can be tracked over stages. A stage is defined as the location of a regional outcome on a reference outcome path. Our method consists of a normalization that maps the time-path of regional outcomes onto a reference outcome path using only pre-policy data. After normalization, the pre-policy outcome paths mapped onto the reference path are identical across regions which implies that the normalization controls for pre-policy regional heterogeneity (the so-called "parallel trends") without taking a stand on its source, (un)observability or (non)constancy. Since regions can differ by stage at any point in time, the normalization uncovers variation in the stage at the time of policy implementation. We use this stage variation at the time of policy implementation to identify the policy effects. We validate our method with a set of Monte-Carlo experiments. We show several applications: public health stay-home policies in Spain (lockdown), the effects of approval of oral contraceptives in 1960 in the U.S. on women's fertility and career choice and the effects of growth policy (e.g. German Reunification).

Double Selection in Causal Inference (2025) joint with Christopher Busch, Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis and Tanya Surovtseva

A long-standing question in research using natural experiments for causal inference is the appropriate functional form of the outcome variable, often involving a choice between level or logarithmic formulations. This choice is crucial because the assumption of a single constant selection bias (CSB)—or, equivalently, a parallel time trend—for identifying the policy effect cannot hold simultaneously in both formulations. To address this issue, we propose a novel double-selection (DS) econometric approach, in which units face two types of selection: a level shifter (single CSB in levels) and a proportional shifter (single CSB in logs). We show unique identification of the DS and, consequently, the causal effects. We propose a DS estimator in levels and conduct inference.

Evaluating the Effectiveness of Policies Against a Pandemic (2023) joint with Christopher Busch, Alexander Ludwig and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis

We apply a novel method to evaluate policies against a pandemic. In the context of the application, the essence of our approach is the insight that epidemic dynamics are best tracked over stages, rather than over time. The application focuses on the nationwide stay-home policy enacted in Spain against the Covid-19 pandemic. We find that the policy saved 16.8% of lives relative to the number of deaths that would have occurred had it not been for the policy intervention. Its effectiveness evolves with the epidemic and is larger when implemented at earlier stages.

Employment and Human Capital Investment Responses to Payroll Tax Reduction (2025) joint with Etienne Wasmer and Pranav Mimani

To counter the negative effects on employment for low-skilled workers, some countries have developed policies that reduce social contributions for low wage workers. We examine the effects of such policies on employment, the incentives to invest in employee training, and salary progression. We propose a model featuring dual heterogeneity of workers and firms, as outlined by Shimer and Smith (2000), to which we add specific human capital accumulation. We calibrate the model on France, where the policy of tax relief, initiated in 1993, has reached a record of 80 billion euros (2.5% of GDP). We find that the reductions in social contributions for low wage workers disincentivize human capital investments and contribute significantly to the high concentration of workers who prefer to keep earning the minimum wage. Our simulations suggest that a one percent reduction of the social contribution subsidy increase average wages by 4% and net employment by 2.5%.

Kramer vs. Kramer. On the importance of Children and Divorce Filings for Understanding Divorce Rates in the USA (2024)

I document that approximately 70% of divorce filings in the 1970's were done by wives in the United States. Since then, this figure has experienced a large decline, reaching 56% in 2015. At the same time, divorce rates sharply increased from 1960 until the mid 1980's and have declined since then. I construct a life cycle model of endogenous marriage and unilateral divorce with endogenous labor supply and savings that jointly explains these facts. I use my model to measure the contribution of changes in the gender-wage gap, property division laws and child custody arrangements in explaining the divorce patterns over time. First, the reduction in the gender-wage gap generates two opposing effects. On the one hand, the reduction of the gender-wage gap increases the value of divorce for married women and, on the other hand, unmarried women become more selective in the marriage market thus raising the quality of newly formed matches. Second, children increase the value of divorce for the custodial parent; so a higher probability of getting child custody raises the chances of filing for divorce. Third, a higher share of assets assigned to wives upon divorce can either increase or decrease divorce rates by altering the savings decision of the household. My model accounts for approximately 50 per cent of the decline in divorce filings and 70 per cent of the variation in divorce rates between 1970 and 2015. I find that the decrease in the gender-wage gap and the increase in the probability of getting child custody for men are major drivers behind the changes in divorce rates and in divorce filings, respectively. Importantly, I find that failure to match who files for divorce can lead to opposite counterfactual results.

A Quantitative Theory of the HIV Epidemic: Education, Risky Sex and Asymmetric Learning (2024) joint work with Daniela Iorio and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis

Using micro survey data, we show that the relationship between education and the probability of HIV infection is U-shaped (positive-zero-positive) over the course of the epidemic. In contrast, the relationship between education and knowledge about the process of HIV infection follows an inverted U-shaped pattern. We develop a non-stationary quantitative macroeconomic theory with heterogeneous agents that is consistent with these facts. Our theory endogenizes the entire course of the HIV epidemic across its different stages: a pre-HIV epidemic stage; a myopic HIV stage in which agents are not aware of the process of HIV infection; a learning stage in which agents heterogeneously---across education groups---learn about the process of infection; and an anti-retroviral (ARV) stage that modifies the effects of HIV infection on individuals. We show that asymmetric learning is key to reproduce both the micro patterns that we document and the aggregate evolution of the HIV epidemic. In further counterfactual experiments, we assess the effects of an early understanding of the virus and its mode of infection, improvements in the composition of education, the earlier (and universal) adoption of ARVs and the use of PrEP to prevent further spread.

HIV Diffusion: Evidence from One Million Blood Tests (2024) joint work with Daniela Iorio and Raül Santaaulàlia-Llopis

We mine 1 million HIV tests in Sub Saharan Africa to empirically show how the HIV epidemic diffuses across demographic and economic groups. We show how the patterns of HIV infection change across stages of the epidemic.

Agricultural productivity in Bolivia before and after the 2006 reform (2022) joint work with Sergio Bobka

We compute a measure of agricultural TPF for Bolivian Agricultural Production Units (APU) before and after the 2006 agricultural reform. Using very detailed farm level census data on input and output quantities in production we are able back out individual farm productivity for the years 1984 and 2013. We then conduct a missallocation exercise where we observe a reduction of the degree of factor missallocation between the years 1984 and 2013, associated to the 2006 land reform.